



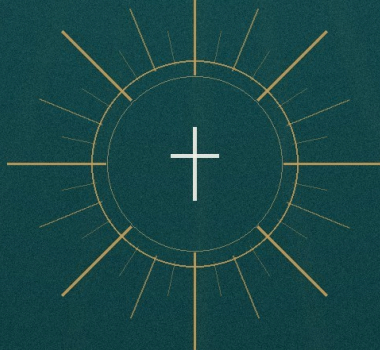
THE CHORUS, ABUJA

Mendelssohn's

ST. PAUL

An Oratorio in Two Parts

PERFORMED BY THE CHORUS, ABUJA



Sunday 13th September 2026

Doors 4:00 PM • Concert 5:00 PM

National Universities Commission Auditorium, Maitama, Abuja

WELCOME

An Oratorio in Two Parts, by Felix Mendelssohn

The Chorus, Abuja, warmly welcomes you to this evening's presentation of Felix Mendelssohn's oratorio **Saint Paul**— a musical retelling of the martyrdom of Stephen and the dramatic conversion of Saul of Tarsus into Paul, apostle to the Gentiles. We invite you to sit back, follow the programme order below, and let the music carry you through this timeless story of faith, persecution, and redemption.

Order of Programme

- Opening Prayer
- Brief Remarks
- Part One — Appeal and Doxology through the Conversion and Baptism of Saul
- Intermission — featuring The Young Chorus
- Part Two — The Mission of Paul and Barnabas through the Persecution of Paul
- Vote of Thanks
- Closing Prayer

DATE	Sunday, 13th September 2026
DOORS OPEN	4:00 PM
CONCERT STARTS	5:00 PM
VENUE	National Universities Commission Auditorium, Maitama, Abuja

THE ARGUMENT

A synopsis of the oratorio

Part I

The persecuted Christian Church in Jerusalem prays to the Lord for power to resist the fury of the Heathen.

Stephen is accused of blasphemy by the incensed people, and is brought before the Council. Being questioned by the High Priest, he reproves his judges for the obstinacy with which they and their fathers have rejected the true faith, and resisted the Holy Ghost. They refuse to hear him, and insist upon putting him to death. Heeding not the reproof that Jerusalem had ever killed the Prophets which had been sent to her, they shout "Stone him to death"; and Stephen suffers martyrdom, praying for mercy upon his persecutors. Devout men carry him to his burial, with much lamentation, and utter words of peace and hope over his grave.

Saul, who is present at the martyrdom, resolves to continue his persecutions of the Christian Church, and for this purpose journeys toward Damascus. A sudden light shines around him, and he is struck with blindness. A voice from Heaven calls upon him to proclaim the glory of the Lord to the benighted people, and his companions lead him by the hand into Damascus. There he prays, in bitter repentance, until the Lord sends to him Ananias, who restores his sight, and confers upon him his divine commission as a Christian preacher. He is baptized, and preaches in the Synagogues; and the congregation praises the wisdom and knowledge of God.

Part II

Saul, who after his conversion takes the name of Paul, preaches before the congregation. Paul and Barnabas are selected by the Holy Ghost, and sent as ambassadors to spread a knowledge of Christianity abroad. The multitude acknowledges them as messengers who preach the gospel of peace.

The Jews, not believing in the Saviour, are envious, and consult how to kill Paul. But Paul and Barnabas, telling them that they have rejected the truth, although they were chosen first to have the word of the Lord set before them, turn from them to preach unto the Gentiles.

Paul miraculously cures a cripple at Lystra; and the Gentiles, believing that the gods have come down from heaven as mortals, call them Jupiter and Mercurius, and desire to offer sacrifices to them. But the Apostles refuse such vain homage; and Paul endeavours to divert the minds of the people from the worship of false idols to that of the one living God. This excites the anger of the multitude; and both Jews and Gentiles accuse him of having spoken against Jehovah's temple and the holy law, and raise a cry of "Stone him". But the Lord, whose help is ever nigh unto the faithful, saves him from persecution.

Paul convokes the elders of Ephesus, telling them that he is bound in the spirit to go forth to Jerusalem, and that they will see his face no more. They weep and pray; but Paul expresses his readiness to die for the Lord, and takes his leave, the elders accompanying him unto the ship. It is their comfort now to be God's own children. To him who has fought a good fight, and kept well the faith, a crown of righteousness shall be given — and not only unto him, the believers sing, but to all them that love His appearing. So they bless the Lord, and praise His holy Name for ever.

ORDER OF MUSIC

Part One

Appeal and Doxology

1		Overture
2	<i>Chorus</i>	Lord, thou alone art God
3	<i>Chorale</i>	To God on high be thanks and praise

Scene One — Stoning of Stephen

4	<i>Recitative & Duet</i>	And the many that believed were of one heart
5	<i>Chorus</i>	Now this man ceaseth not
6	<i>Recitative & Chorus</i>	And all that sat in the council
7	<i>Aria (S)</i>	Jerusalem! thou that killed the Prophets
8	<i>Recitative & Chorus</i>	Then they ran upon him; Stone him!
9	<i>Recitative & Chorale</i>	And they stoned him; To thee, O Lord
10	<i>Recitative</i>	And the witnesses
11	<i>Chorus</i>	Happy and blest are they

Scene Two — Conversion and Baptism of Saul (Paul)

12	<i>Recitative (T) & Aria (B)</i>	And Saul made havock of the Church
13	<i>Recitative & Arioso (S)</i>	But the Lord is mindful of His own
14	<i>Recitative & Chorus</i>	And as he journeyed; Saul, why do you persecute me?
15	<i>Chorus</i>	Rise up, Arise! Let there be light!
16	<i>Chorale</i>	Sleepers wake
17	<i>Recitative</i>	And his companions
18	<i>Aria (B)</i>	O God, have Mercy
19	<i>Recitative</i>	And there was a Disciple
20	<i>Aria (B) & Chorus</i>	I praise thee, O Lord
21	<i>Recitative</i>	And Ananias went his way
22	<i>Chorus</i>	O great is the depth

— INTERMISSION —
Featuring *The Young Chorus*

ORDER OF MUSIC

Part Two

Scene Three — Mission of Paul and Barnabas

23	<i>Chorus</i>	The nations are now the Lord's
24	<i>Recitative (S)</i>	And Paul came to the congregation
25	<i>Duetto (TB)</i>	Now we are ambassadors
26	<i>Chorus</i>	How lovely are the messengers
27	<i>Recitative & Arioso (S)</i>	I will sing of thy great mercies

Scene Four — Persecution of Paul by his Former Fellow Believers

28	<i>Recitative (T) & Chorus</i>	But when the Jews; Thus saith the Lord
29	<i>Chorus & Chorale</i>	Is this he?; O Thou, the true and only light
30	<i>Recitative (TB)</i>	But Paul and Barnabas spoke freely
31	<i>Duet (TB)</i>	For so hath the Lord
32	<i>Recitative (S)</i>	And there was a man at Lystra
33	<i>Chorus</i>	The gods themselves
34	<i>Recitative (A)</i>	And they called Barnabas Jupiter
35	<i>Quartet</i>	O be gracious, ye immortals
36	<i>Recitative, Aria (B) & Chorus</i>	Now when the Apostles; For know ye not?
37	<i>Recitative (S)</i>	Then the multitude
38	<i>Chorus</i>	This is the Lord's temple
39	<i>Recitative (S)</i>	And they all persecuted Paul
40	<i>Cavatina (T)</i>	Be thou faithful unto death
41	<i>Recitative</i>	And Paul sent and called the elders
42	<i>Chorus & Recitative (SATB)</i>	Far be it from thy path
43	<i>Chorus</i>	See what love
44	<i>Recitative (S)</i>	And though he be offered
45	<i>Chorus</i>	Not only unto him

Vote of Thanks • Closing Prayer

CHARACTERS

Paul (Saul)	Budubueze Ozuru
Barnabas	Uzochukwu Onunwa
Ananias	Jude Agbaje
Stephen	Daniel Nwuche
High Priest	Chuka Ikuni
False Witnesses	Isaac Oburu & Promise Ofonakara
Narrators	Blessing Igoni, Raphael Ipalibo & Nengi Okara
Voice of God	Deborah Egede & Ezekiel Whyte
The Elders	Tochukwu Uche & Deinma Ogan
Gentile Priests	Rose Nwachi, Biebele Eretoru, Chidera Nnam & Deborah Egede
Elders of Ephesus	Milliscent Jagusa, Amarachi Okpara, Jude Agbaje & Chinedu Allison
Alto Aria	Ngozi Owutu
Tenor Aria	Victor Ifenwata
Disciples / Mob /Gentiles	The Chorus
The Young Chorus	Buduka & Buduoma Ozuru
Extras	Tochukwu John, Abraham Kolo, Collins Edjoro, David Oyetoro Chukwusom Okafor

Production Team

Dramaturg	Nengi Okara
Scene Display Director	Uzor Ahanotu
Artistic Director	Kenneth Emerie
Music Director / Conductor	Kelechi Nnam

THE CHORUS

List of performers

1st Sopranos

Benita Augustine
Blessing Igoni
Gold Omeire
Joy Asekhamen
Margaret Eyindenghan
Millicent Jagusa
Nengi Okara
Precious Kanu

2nd Sopranos

Deima Ogan
Esther Udju
Ezekiel Whyte
Rose Nwachi

1st Altos

Amarachi Okpara
Biebele Eretoru
Chidera Nnam
Damilola Ayeni

2nd Altos

Esther Ike
Ngozi Owutu
Pascal Gozie
Tochukwu Uche

1st Tenors

Raphael Ipalibo
Uzochukwu Onunwa
Victor Ifenwata

2nd Tenors

Daniel Nwuche
Jude Agbaje

Baritones

Chidi Amadi
Chinedu Allison
Isaac Oburu

Basses

Budubueze Ozuru
Chuka Ikuni
Promise Ofonakara

THE ORCHESTRA

Accompanists and instrumentalists

Accompanists

Iheanyi Owutu
Kenneth Elekwachi
Seyi Ayinde

1st Violins

Israel Eze
Katja Uchejuafor
Mbetobong Edet Sunday
Simon Jethro

2nd Violins

Idowu Joseph Adeyeye
Dania Patrick Amefo
Susan Oluwatoyin Ogundare

Violas

Chidinma Francisca Igboekwe
Kodili Okolo

Cello

Michael Chiedozie Uzomah
Olutola Taiwo

Trumpets

Miracle Onyekachukwu
Onyekachi Daniel Uzoma

Trombones

Atagozawanyi Zacchaeus Maiwada
Israel Dominic

Timpani

Akpan Ubong

Music Director / Conductor

Kelechi Nnam

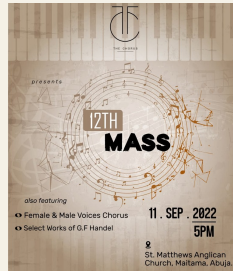
With heartfelt gratitude to our sponsors, families, and friends who have made this evening's performance possible. Thank you for joining us.

OUR PREVIOUS CONCERTS

A look back at our journey together, in order of performance



The Creation Story
28th November 2021



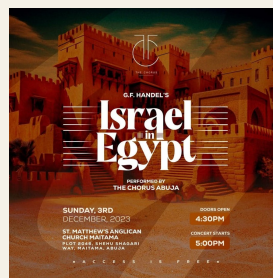
12th Mass
11th September 2022



Christ is Born — The Christmas Story
17th December 2022



The Resurrection
30th March 2023



Israel in Egypt
3rd December 2023



The Crucifixion
29th March 2024 (Good Friday)



Elijah
3rd November 2024



Christ on Mount Olives
13th April 2025



Handel's Solomon
16th November 2025



Hymn of Praise
22nd March 2026

THANK YOU FOR JOINING US

For Sponsorship and Support

Stanbic IBTC — Account No. 0081339797

Enquiries

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www.thechorusabuja.org
